

PHONES

Nokia 6610

Price: Rs 12,349 **B+**

At an estimated street price of Rs 12,349, the Nokia 6610 offers the perfect balance of features, looks and price. Its signal reception is excellent and voice clarity superb.

Its keypad is the best we've seen on any Nokia phone—it offers the right amount of tactile feedback. The four-way keypad combined with a super-slick menu interface offers usability that's best in its class. There are 12 main menus to choose from.



The radio offers crystal-clear reception, but you need to plug in the headset even when you're listening through the speakerphone, since the set doubles up as the antenna. The inbuilt ringtones are audible enough to alert you to incoming calls—even in noisy areas.

Introduced a year ago, the Nokia 6610 still manages to captivate, due to its ample feature set and clean business looks that should appeal to most executives. Its candybar design is elegant and the colours accentuate the 'executive' look, without being too flashy. Weighing 83 gm, the phone is light and pocketable, though some might find it a bit stretched out. Though its looks and features are very similar to those of the 6100, there are a few minor differences that set them apart: For example, this one—the 6610—comes with a stereo FM receiver.

Its feature set includes a colour display, tri-band compatibility, wireless Java and MMS, apart from the stereo FM receiver. The 4K colour screen is a let-down when compared to the dazzling screens on the new phones from Samsung and LG. The screen also shows some amount of banding and flicker when playing games.

Battery life shouldn't be a concern, since it can last at least three days with normal usage—up to a maximum of five days.

Nokia 6100

Price: Rs 13,039 **B+**

Priced at Rs 13,039, the Nokia 6100 is the phone for you if you lust after slim phones (and this one's got decent features to boot). This is, in fact, the slimmest phone Nokia has come up with so far. Voice is clear and signal reception quite good. Design-wise, the phone is identical to Nokia's 6610—minor tweaks have reduced its size. The 6100 comes with a new battery design that slims down the form factor and gives it a four-day operating range with normal use.

Usability-wise, the 6100 offers the usual Nokia menu interface, which is widely accepted as the best and easiest to use. Its small 4K colour screen offers decent vibrancy and does not pose any readability problems in direct sunlight. You can read five lines of text in a crisp font on this little screen. Other features such as tri-band compatibility, MMS, polyphonic ringtones, GPRS and Java enhance the usability of the phone.

The body sports a good colour combination that gives this



phone the business exec look. However, unlike on other Nokia phones, it can't be changed. The keypad offers decent styling, and the keys respond in a crisp business-like manner and offer good tactile feel.

Applications provided are limited, but the 180 KB of free memory is more than enough for downloading extra applications.

Nokia 7250i

Price: Rs 18,759 **C+**

Priced at Rs 18,759, the 7250i stands out for its feature package and good looks. The 7250i succeeds the beautiful 7210. While the new phone looks like an exact copy of the 7210, it has improved considerably over its predecessor.

The new look is accentuated by the use of plastic cases that look like brushed aluminium, giving the phone an element of distinctness. You can snap on covers of your choice, too. The 7250i comes with a very ergonomic keypad.

Owing to better brightness and contrast features, its 4K colour screen is better than the ones on its cousins, the 6610 and 6100. One feature that sets this phone apart is the integrated camera, which supports a maximum resolution of 352 x 288. Options include portrait mode and a self-timer, and the option to choose between three photo qualities. The phone has 4 MB of memory, so there's enough space to save photos and install new applications and games.

The menu interface is the same old Nokia story—slick and easy-to-use is how we'd sum it up. Good features include tri-band GSM, a stereo FM receiver, MMS, GPRS and IrDA. Call quality is good, too, and the battery lasts for 4 to 5 days if you're on the phone for a total of an hour a day.



Nokia 7200

Price: Rs 25,919 **C**

Nokia's finally come up with a clamshell-design phone. The unique thing about this phone is the cloth-textured 'Xpress-on' covers, which add an element of dash to the phone.

Reception is good, and there should be no problems with voice clarity. The battery lasts for three to four days with normal use. Priced at Rs 25,919 the 7200 is on the higher side compared to rival models.

The two rectangular halves of the phone are joined by an outward-protruding hinge, giving the phone a chunky look. While most of the men in our office weren't impressed, the fairer sex just loved the idea of having matching textile covers for phones.

The keypad is nice and big, and the white backlight

